

Community workshop handbook

A practical guide to making things together.

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Every community begins with a small invitation. This chapter explores how we can make space for neighbours to read, learn and work together. A workshop is a place where questions are welcome and knowledge moves in both directions.

Start with a table, a few useful materials and time to listen. Ask what people need. Write down the answers without trying to solve everything at once. Keep the language simple and give everyone a chance to contribute.

Listen before you plan

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Shared gardens, reading rooms and local archives grow through patient care. Share the notes openly, credit the people who helped and make the next step clear. A good invitation gives people a reason to return.

Try this: invite three neighbours to bring something they have learned. Read the notes aloud. Find one small idea you can put into practice before the next meeting.

Make a welcoming room

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